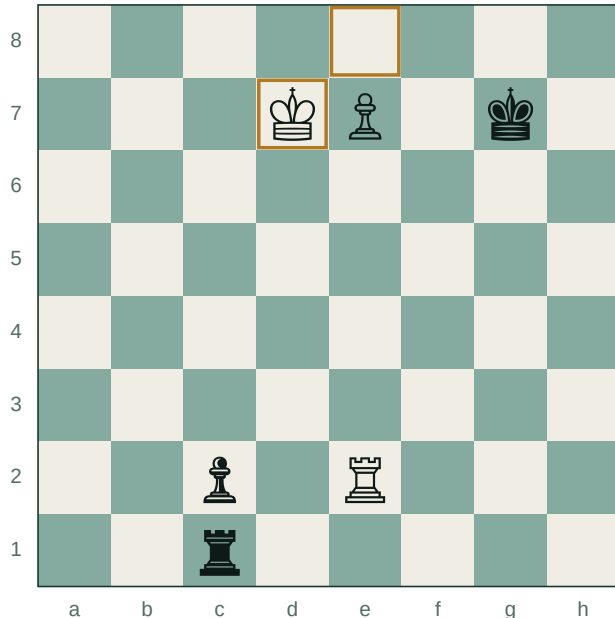


Clearance tactics: Black, move 59

Clearance tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 59.Kd7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

59...Rd1+ 60. Ke6 c1=Q

59...Rd1+ Check restricts White to 6 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **60.Ke6**.

60...c1=Q The pawn moves from c2 to c1. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 6 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +8:** the balance goes from +0 to +8. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on d7. Geometrically undefended: rook on e2. Check for tactical protection.